

D258

Organizational Leadership in Healthcare

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A clinic director at a network with a new rooftop garden spends her time removing barriers for staff, asking what they need, and putting their growth and patients' needs ahead of her own status. The network has 9 clinics. Which leadership style is this?

- A. Servant leadership
- B. Transactional leadership
- C. Autocratic leadership
- D. Laissez-faire leadership

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A consultant visiting a hospital with a new parking garage notes that the mission statement says "safety first," but staff unconsciously assume that questioning physicians will be punished. The hospital has 450 beds. Which level of culture most drives behavior here?

- A. Artifacts
- B. Espoused values
- C. Basic underlying assumptions
- D. The mission statement, which always determines behavior

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an artifact in Schein's model?

- A. Artifacts are the hardest level to see.
- B. A stated value that "we put patients first"
- C. An open office layout and color-coded staff badges
- D. A shared, unspoken belief that leaders can't be questioned

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A newly formed patient-flow team at a hospital with a new logo has members arguing about roles and whose ideas should lead. The team meets on Tuesdays. Which stage is it in?

- A. Storming
- B. Norming
- C. Performing
- D. Forming

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has agreed on roles and ground rules, and members give feedback freely, though they are not yet fully self-directed. Which stage is this?

- A. Performing
- B. Storming
- C. Norming
- D. Adjourning

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

Two unit managers at a hospital that just won a quality award disagree about sharing float nurses. Both goals matter, the relationship is long-term, and they have time to talk. They have both worked there 15 years. Which conflict mode fits best?

- A. Collaborating
- B. Compromising
- C. Accommodating
- D. Avoiding

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation calls for a competing (forcing) conflict mode?

- A. A long-term partnership where both sides' goals are important
- B. A safety emergency that needs a quick, decisive action
- C. Every disagreement with staff
- D. A minor issue that matters more to the other person

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

At a hospital with a new cafeteria, one executive focuses on budgets, schedules, and staffing plans, while another inspires staff with a vision of becoming the region's leader in stroke care. The second executive recently ran a half-marathon. Which statement is accurate?

- A. Only people with formal titles can lead.
- B. The first is leading; the second is managing.
- C. Management and leadership are the same thing.
- D. The first is managing; the second is leading.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A nurse manager of a unit that recently repainted its walls wants staff to report near misses. Last month, a nurse who reported one was criticized in a staff meeting. The unit has 40 staff. What is the best action?

- A. Require reporting and penalize anyone who fails to report.
- B. Build psychological safety: thank reporters, respond without blame, and model admitting her own mistakes.
- C. Stop asking, since near misses never matter when no harm occurs.
- D. Make reports anonymous and change nothing else.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A hospital leadership team with a new boardroom quickly agrees to a costly expansion. No one raises concerns, and the CEO dismisses one doubt as "negativity." The meeting ran 20 minutes. What best prevents this problem?

- A. Nothing, since groupthink only happens in small teams.
- B. Require unanimous votes on major decisions.
- C. Simply make meetings longer.
- D. Invite dissent, assign a devil's advocate, and seek outside review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A staff nurse with no formal title at a hospital with a new ED wing is the go-to person on her unit because she is certified in wound care and knows the most about it. Her car is a hybrid. Which power base does she use?

- A.** Referent power
- B.** Expert power
- C.** Legitimate power
- D.** Coercive power

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A supervisor gets compliance by threatening to change the schedules of staff who disagree with her. Which power base is this?

- A.** Expert power
- B.** Reward power
- C.** Legitimate power
- D.** Coercive power

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A clinic director ~~at a network with a new rooftop garden~~ spends her time removing barriers for staff, asking what they need, and putting their growth and patients' needs ahead of her own status. ~~The network has 9 clinics.~~ Which leadership style is this?

Target word: leadership style **Decides:** Serving followers' needs first.

A	Correct	Puts followers and their growth first.
B	Confusion set	Exchanges rewards for performance.
C	Inverted operation	Leader-centered control, the opposite.
D	Adjacent category	Hands-off; she is actively engaged.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A consultant visiting a hospital ~~with a new parking garage~~ notes that the mission statement says "safety first," but staff unconsciously assume that questioning physicians will be punished. ~~The hospital has 450 beds.~~ Which level of culture most drives behavior here?

Target word: Schein level **Decides:** Unconscious shared beliefs.

A	Adjacent category	Visible structures and symbols.
B	Confusion set	Stated values like "safety first" can differ from real behavior.
C	Correct	The deepest level drives behavior.
D	Absolute language	Stated values often conflict with assumptions.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Which is an artifact in Schein's model?

Target word: identify artifact **Decides:** Visible and tangible.

A	Adjacent category	Artifacts are the easiest to see but hardest to interpret.
B	Confusion set	An espoused value.
C	Correct	Visible elements of culture.
D	Inverted operation	That is the deepest level.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A newly formed patient-flow team ~~at a hospital with a new logo~~ has members arguing about roles and whose ideas should lead. ~~The team meets on Tuesdays.~~ Which stage is it in?

Target word: Tuckman stage **Decides:** Conflict over roles and ideas.

A	Correct	Conflict and competition over roles.
B	Adjacent category	Norming comes after conflict is resolved.
C	Inverted operation	Performing teams work smoothly.
D	Confusion set	Forming is polite orientation.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A team has agreed on roles and ground rules, and members give feedback freely, though they are not yet fully self-directed. Which stage is this?

Target word: Tuckman stage **Decides:** Shared norms, not yet high-performing.

A	Adjacent category	Performing teams are fully self-directed.
B	Inverted operation	Conflict has already been resolved.
C	Correct	Norms and cohesion are established.
D	Confusion set	The team is not disbanding.

6. Answer A Concept 4

Two unit managers at a hospital ~~that just won a quality award~~ disagree about sharing float nurses. Both goals matter, the relationship is long-term, and they have time to talk. ~~They have both worked there 15 years.~~ Which conflict mode fits best?

Target word: conflict mode **Decides:** High stakes for both, long-term relationship, time available.

A	Correct	Seeks a solution that fully meets both needs.
B	Adjacent category	Each gives up part of an important goal.
C	Confusion set	One side gives up its goal.
D	Inverted operation	Leaves an important issue unresolved.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Which situation calls for a competing (forcing) conflict mode?

Target word: when to compete **Decides:** Urgent safety decision.

A	Confusion set	Fits collaborating.
B	Correct	Speed and safety outweigh consensus.
C	Absolute language	Forcing everything damages relationships.
D	Adjacent category	Fits accommodating.

8. Answer D Concept 5

~~At a hospital with a new cafeteria,~~ one executive focuses on budgets, schedules, and staffing plans, while another inspires staff with a vision of becoming the region's leader in stroke care. ~~The second executive recently ran a half marathon.~~ Which statement is accurate?

Target word: distinguish the roles **Decides:** Planning/control vs. vision/influence.

A	Absolute language	Leadership can come from any position.
B	Inverted operation	Reversed.
C	Confusion set	They overlap but are distinct.
D	Correct	Management plans and controls; leadership sets vision.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A nurse manager of a unit ~~that recently repainted its walls~~ wants staff to report near misses. Last month, a nurse who reported one was criticized in a staff meeting. ~~The unit has 40 staff.~~ What is the best action?

Target word: build reporting culture **Decides:** Fear of blame is blocking reports.

A	Inverted operation	Adds fear instead of removing it.
B	Correct	Safety makes speaking up normal.
C	Absolute language	Near misses reveal system weaknesses.
D	Dropped element	Leaves the blaming culture in place.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A hospital leadership team ~~with a new boardroom~~ quickly agrees to a costly expansion. No one raises concerns, and the CEO dismisses one doubt as “negativity.” ~~The meeting ran 20 minutes.~~ What best prevents this problem?

Target word: groupthink prevention **Decides:** Dissent is suppressed.

A	Absolute language	It can affect any cohesive group.
B	Inverted operation	Increases pressure to conform.
C	Camouflage	Meeting length does not address suppressed dissent.
D	Correct	Brings suppressed views into the open.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A staff nurse with no formal title ~~at a hospital with a new ED wing~~ is the go-to person on her unit because she is certified in wound care and knows the most about it. ~~Her car is a hybrid.~~ Which power base does she use?

Target word: power base **Decides:** Influence from knowledge.

A	Adjacent category	Referent power comes from personal admiration.
B	Correct	Based on specialized knowledge.
C	Confusion set	She has no formal position.
D	Inverted operation	Based on punishment.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

A supervisor gets compliance by threatening to change the schedules of staff who disagree with her. Which power base is this?

Target word: power base **Decides:** Threat of punishment.

A	Confusion set	Based on knowledge.
B	Inverted operation	Reward offers benefits, not threats.
C	Adjacent category	Position alone, without threats.
D	Correct	Influence through threatened punishment.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	1	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Servant leadership	Servant leaders put followers' growth and needs first and remove barriers so others can succeed.	Mistaking support for a hands-off style.	A leader focused on staff needs over status.
2	Schein's levels of culture	Artifacts (visible), espoused values (stated), and basic assumptions (unconscious) — assumptions drive behavior most.	Assuming stated values or mission statements drive behavior.	Stated values conflict with unspoken beliefs.
3	Tuckman's team stages	Forming → storming (conflict over roles) → norming (shared rules) → performing → adjourning.	Mixing up storming and norming.	Team behavior described at a moment.
4	Conflict modes	Collaborating fits important goals and relationships with time to talk; competing fits emergencies; compromising splits the difference.	Defaulting to compromise when both goals matter.	Stakes, relationship, and time available.
5	Leadership vs. management	Management plans, organizes, and controls; leadership sets vision and influences people.	Thinking they are identical or tied to titles.	Budgets and schedules vs. vision.
6	Psychological safety	People speak up when leaders respond to reports without blame and model admitting mistakes.	Mandating reports with penalties.	Staff criticized for reporting.
7	Groupthink	Cohesive groups suppress dissent; invite dissent, assign a devil's advocate, and seek outside review.	Requiring unanimity or assuming only small groups are affected.	Quick agreement and dismissed doubts.
8	Bases of power	Legitimate (position), reward, coercive (punishment), expert (knowledge), referent (personal admiration).	Confusing expert with legitimate or referent power.	Where the influence comes from.

Course scope (public description): Organizational Leadership in Healthcare provides students with an overview of the principles and practices leaders need in healthcare environments. The course focuses on organizational leadership theory, behaviors, culture, and teamwork. This course prepares students to apply leadership theories, principles of organizational culture development, techniques for building and leading teams, and conflict resolution strategies to support organizational goals. This course has no prerequisites.